MATH INQUIRERS PLACEMENT CHECK

Ages 6-8

Typically children finishing Primary 1, and open to a year either side • About 30 minutes • No calculator

Name: _____ Date: _____

How it works. Your child answers on their own. Read a question aloud if they ask, but do not help with the maths. If they are stuck, say "Try your best, or skip it", and move on. Write the answer in the box. Working on scrap paper is fine.

Warm-up

1 What number comes just after 14?

2 Which is bigger, 17 or 12?

3 I have 6 sweets. I get 3 more. How many sweets now?

4 What shape has 3 sides?

Main questions

5 What number goes with 7 to make 10?

6 Here is a pattern: 5, 10, 15, then what comes next?

7 A pencil costs 40 cents. An eraser costs 30 cents. How much for both?

8 5 children like apples. 3 like bananas. 2 like grapes. How many more like apples than grapes?

9 A pen is 8 cubes long. A ruler is 12 cubes long. How many cubes longer is the ruler?

10 Ali is taller than Ben. Ben is taller than Cai. Who is the shortest?

Brain stretchers

11 Two numbers add up to 10. One is 4 more than the other. What are the two numbers?

12 I have 5 coins. Some are 10-cent coins and some are 5-cent coins. Together they make 40 cents. How many of each?

FOR THE TUTOR OR PARENT

Answer key and scoring

Accept equivalent forms (for example $2.05 and 2.05). One mark per question.

Warm-up (4 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
1	What number comes just after 14?	**15**	Watch whether the child counts on from 14 or restarts from 1.
2	Which is bigger, 17 or 12?	**17**	Ask how they know. Common error: choosing the number said first.
3	I have 6 sweets. I get 3 more. How many sweets now?	**9**	Watch for counting on fingers or objects (fine) versus guessing.
4	What shape has 3 sides?	**triangle**	Accept 'triangle'. Note if the child confuses it with a square or says 'pyramid'.

Main questions (6 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
5	What number goes with 7 to make 10?	**3**	Does the child know the bond, or count up from 7 on fingers?
6	Here is a pattern: 5, 10, 15, then what comes next?	**20**	Look for counting in 5s. Common error: 16 (adding 1) or 25.
7	A pencil costs 40 cents. An eraser costs 30 cents. How much for both?	**70 cents**	Watch tens-and-ones thinking (4 tens + 3 tens). Common error: 7 cents or 10 cents.
8	5 children like apples. 3 like bananas. 2 like grapes. How many more like apples than grapes?	**3**	Common error: adding (7) or giving the apple count (5) instead of comparing.
9	A pen is 8 cubes long. A ruler is 12 cubes long. How many cubes longer is the ruler?	**4**	Does the child compare (12 - 8) or add? Ask them to show with fingers or cubes.
10	Ali is taller than Ben. Ben is taller than Cai. Who is the shortest?	**Cai**	Ask the child to line them up. Common error: answering Ben or Ali.

Brain stretchers (2 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
11	Two numbers add up to 10. One is 4 more than the other. What are the two numbers?	**3 and 7**	Look for trial and error with bonds to 10 (good). Common error: 4 and 6, which only differ by 2.
12	I have 5 coins. Some are 10-cent coins and some are 5-cent coins. Together they make 40 cents. How many of each?	**3 ten-cent coins and 2 five-cent coins**	Look for guess-and-check. Common error: 4 and 1, which has the right count but makes 45 cents.

YOUR CHILD'S RESULT

Which level fits?

Add up the marks, then find your row. This is a guide. You make the final choice, and you can change level free of charge before lesson 1.

Warm-up marks: _____ / 4 **Main + stretch marks:** _____ / 8

Main + stretch	What it suggests
6 to 8	Join **Ages 6-8 (P1)**. Your child has the foundations and will be well challenged. If they scored 8 of 8 and all 4 warm-up marks, you can also try the Ages 7-9 (P2) check.
4 or 5	Join **Ages 6-8 (P1)**, and expect some support. If the warm-up score is 2 or less, a tutor chat and the free taster first may be the more comfortable start.
0 to 3	We suggest **a tutor chat and the free taster first**. The ideas build step by step, and a confident start matters more than a fast one.

Strong?
Choose the level that fits the score, not the school year. A child who finds this easy will enjoy the challenge questions in class.

Not yet?
That is useful to know, not a failure. Starting one level down means more success and more joy in class.

Skills covered

counting to 20; comparing numbers; add within 20; basic shapes; number bonds to 10; number patterns; money (cents); simple graphs; length comparison; logic ordering

Next step. Send the score and your preferred level to us when you enrol. Prices are the same at every level, and your tutor can talk it through first. Small groups of up to 8, live online.